MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準2級プラス
リーディングトレーニング

第7回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検準2級プラス形式のリーディング第7回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To prevent flooding during autumn typhoons, the city decided to ( ) the narrow drainage canal.

1 weaken **2** widen **3** whisper **4** wander

(2) All laboratory coats must be hung in the hallway locker room without ( ) before entering the cafeteria.

1 favor **2** fault **3** fear **4** fail

(3) Even experienced hikers can lose their bearings when dense mist ( ) in over the ridge.

1 closes **2** counts **3** calls **4** carries

(4) The new recycling guide provides a clear ( ) between plastics that can be washed and reused and those that cannot.

1 distraction **2** destination **3** distinction **4** destruction

(5) Applicants for the summer museum internship will be selected on the ( ) of an essay and a short interview.

1 balance **2** basis **3** border **4** bottom

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) Many shopkeepers were initially (　　) to switch to digital receipts, fearing older customers would find them confusing.

1 reliable　**2** relevant　**3** reluctant　**4** redundant

(7) Regularly oiling the hinges will (　　) the life of your garden gate in salty coastal air.

1 prohibit　**2** postpone　**3** pretend　**4** prolong

(8) Because the two melodies sounded almost identical, only trained musicians noticed the (　　) difference in rhythm.

1 subtle　**2** sudden　**3** severe　**4** shallow

(9) Demand for insulated lunch jars has grown (　　) over the past three winters as students bring hot soup to school.

1 loosely　**2** scarcely　**3** secretly　**4** steadily

(10) The ferry ticket includes a boxed lunch; (　　), passengers may bring their own snacks on board.

1 otherwise　**2** furthermore　**3** nevertheless　**4** instead

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(11) No student is (　　) from taking the annual swimming safety lesson unless excused by a doctor.

1 eager　**2** exact　**3** exempt　**4** empty

(12) All library laptops will restart at noon (　　) a scheduled security software update.

1 for the purpose of　**2** in spite of　**3** instead of　**4** apart from

(13) To (　　) confusion at the baggage carousel, attach a colored strap to your black suitcase.

1 afford　**2** avoid　**3** appoint　**4** approve

(14) Even minor tire wear can affect braking distance (　　) on rain-soaked highways.

1 noticeably　**2** narrowly　**3** casually　**4** politely

(15) A broken water pipe in the basement temporarily (　　) afternoon classes in the east wing.

1 dissolved　**2** displayed　**3** distributed　**4** disrupted

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(16) On (　　) of the entire brass band, our captain thanked the local shopkeepers for their donations.

1 average　**2** account　**3** behalf　**4** purpose

(17) Only after tasting the soup (　　) that he had grabbed the sugar jar instead of the salt.

1 Ken realized　**2** did Ken realize　**3** realized Ken　**4** Ken did realize

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Groceries Use Curved Shopping Cart Tracks on Ramps

Multi-story supermarkets in compact city neighborhoods face a logistical puzzle: how can customers move heavy carts full of milk, rice, and vegetables smoothly between floors? Ordinary passenger elevators fill up after just two or three carts, while regular stepped escalators cannot carry wheeled baskets safely.

Many urban stores solve this with inclined moving walkways—flat, grooved metal belts that climb slowly from floor to floor. At first glance, keeping a thirty-kilogram cart from rolling backward down a twelve-degree slope looks risky, especially if a shopper lets go of the handle to check a shopping list. Yet no motors or handbrakes are attached to the carts themselves. (18), the secret lies in the precise spacing of the cart's wheels and the narrow slots cut into the walkway floor.

As a cart rolls onto the ramp, its thin rubber tires drop neatly between raised metal ribs, allowing the slightly wider brake pads beside each wheel to rest directly on top of the ribs. Friction between those pads and the metal surface locks the cart firmly in place until it reaches the flat landing at the top, where a gentle comb plate lifts the tires out again. (19), shoppers can ride hands-free without fear of a runaway basket.

Because every cart wheel must match the walkway's rib width to the millimeter, stores cannot mix carts from different manufacturers. This quiet mechanical partnership shows how (20).

(18)

1 Meanwhile
2 Otherwise
3 Similarly
4 Instead

(19)

1 Consequently
2 Nevertheless
3 On the contrary
4 Previously

(20)

1 shopping carts work best when every wheel has a different size
2 customers prefer carrying thirty kilograms of groceries up stairs by hand
3 matching two simple shapes can solve a safety challenge without electronics
4 elevators are faster when carts have square wooden wheels

How Oyster Reefs Calm Coastal Waves

When coastal towns think about defending harbors and roads against storm waves, concrete seawalls usually come to mind first. Massive walls block water effectively at the start, yet waves crashing against vertical concrete scour away sand at the base, requiring expensive repairs decade after decade. Over time, concrete barriers also replace shallow tidal zones where young fish once sheltered.

Marine engineers and ecologists have been testing a living complement in sheltered bays: artificial reefs seeded with native oysters. Young oysters attach themselves to shells or limestone blocks on the seafloor, cementing new layers atop old ones year after year. Unlike a rigid wall that wears down after construction, a healthy oyster reef actually grows denser and slightly taller as sea levels inch upward. (21), its rough, uneven surface breaks the energy of incoming waves before they strike the shore.

Water quality improves alongside shoreline stability. A single adult oyster filters dozens of liters of murky bay water a day, removing excess algae so sunlight can reach underwater eelgrass meadows again. (22), crabs, shrimp, and juvenile rockfish return to hide in the maze of shells.

Oyster reefs cannot replace concrete barriers along open ocean cliffs hit by giant typhoons. In calm estuaries and inner harbors, however, combining modest stone sills with living shell beds offers (23).

(21)

1 Otherwise
2 Moreover
3 Instead
4 However

(22)

1 At random
2 Even so
3 In turn
4 By contrast

(23)

1 protection against earthquakes high in inland mountains
2 a way to drain every bay completely dry for parking lots
3 an excuse to dump factory waste directly onto beaches
4 shoreline protection that repairs itself while enriching marine life

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Borrowing Musical Scores from the Regional Archive

From: Prefectural Youth Orchestra Library
To: Section Leaders
Subject: Handling rules for borrowed orchestral sheet music

Dear section leaders,
Sheet music folders for our winter symphony program are ready to pick up starting tomorrow afternoon. Because two of the pieces are rented from a national music publisher under a strict contract, please share these handling rules with everyone in your instrument section before the first rehearsal.

Players may write bowings, breath marks, and fingerings ONLY with soft 2B or 4B lead pencils. Ballpoint pens, highlighters, and erasable friction pens are strictly forbidden—friction-pen ink can reappear in cold delivery trucks even after being rubbed out, resulting in heavy replacement fines from the publisher.

Do not remove staples or tape loose pages together. If a page tear makes turning difficult on the stand, bring the folder to the orchestra librarian before rehearsal so archival paper tape can be applied cleanly. All numbered folders must be returned with markings fully erased within three days after the December concert.

Thank you for your care,
M. Kurosawa, Orchestra Librarian

Borrowing Musical Scores from the Regional Archive — Questions

(24) Why are erasable friction pens banned on the rented sheet music?

1 Their ink can reappear in cold temperatures during transport and trigger publisher fines.

2 They smudge violin strings when players turn pages.

3 They cannot write numbers on shiny paper.

4 Only conductors are allowed to buy friction pens.

(25) What writing tool ARE players permitted to use on the sheet music?

1 Yellow highlighters.

2 Black ballpoint pens.

3 Permanent blue markers.

4 Soft 2B or 4B lead pencils.

(26) What should a player do if a torn page is hard to turn on the music stand?

1 Staple it to the cardboard folder.

2 Bring it to the orchestra librarian before rehearsal for archival tape repair.

3 Copy the entire piece on a home printer.

4 Throw the torn page away after the concert.

Why Mapmakers Deliberately Straightened Subway Lines

Early transit maps of major cities in the 1910s and 1920s tried faithfully to show every twist of a railway line atop an accurate street map. As networks expanded, however, the results became nearly unreadable. Central business districts were crammed with tiny overlapping station names, while long suburban branches stretched off the edges of pocket folders.

In 1931, an electrical engineering draftsman named Harry Beck noticed something crucial while sketching London's Underground during a layoff. Once passengers descend beneath the pavement, they cannot see curving streets or rivers anyway; what they really need to know is which line to board, how many stops remain, and where two lines intersect. Drawing inspiration from electrical circuit diagrams—where wires are arranged neatly at horizontal, vertical, and forty-five-degree angles regardless of physical length—Beck compressed distant suburbs and enlarged the crowded center.

Transit managers initially rejected Beck's draft as too radical, fearing riders would misjudge walking distances on the surface. When the Underground printed a small trial run in 1933, however, commuters embraced its clarity immediately. Within decades, Tokyo, Paris, New York, and Sydney adopted similar schematic diagrams.

The trade-off managers worried about never completely vanished, though. Tourists consulting a schematic subway diagram sometimes take two train transfers to travel between stations that sit just four hundred meters apart above ground. To bridge this gap, several modern transit apps and station boards now blend both worlds—keeping clean geometric lines while adding dotted ten-minute walking arcs or subtle river contours.

Beck's insight remains a classic lesson in information design: leaving out geographic detail that does not serve the user's immediate task can make complex systems far easier to navigate.

Why Mapmakers Deliberately Straightened Subway Lines — Questions

(27) Why did early geographically accurate transit maps become difficult to use as networks grew?

1 They were printed without any station names.

2 Subway trains changed routes every morning.

3 Central areas became cluttered with overlapping labels while suburban lines ran off the page.

4 Passengers refused to fold paper maps into pockets.

(28) Where did Harry Beck get the visual idea for his 1931 subway diagram?

1 From electrical circuit diagrams using neat horizontal, vertical, and 45-degree lines.

2 From oil paintings of the River Thames.

3 From medieval sailing charts.

4 From aerial photographs taken from balloons.

(29) Why did transit managers hesitate to approve Beck's design at first?

1 It used twenty expensive metallic inks.

2 They worried passengers might misjudge actual surface walking distances.

3 It left out every transfer station in central London.

4 Draftsmen were not allowed to ride the Underground.

(30) What drawback of schematic subway diagrams is mentioned in the fourth paragraph?

1 Visitors may take indirect train transfers between stations that are a short walk apart above ground.

2 Suburban residents cannot find their home stations on the chart.

3 Locomotives get lost inside tunnels.

4 Digital screens cannot display 45-degree lines clearly.

(31) How are some modern transit maps addressing that drawback?

1 By returning to unmarked satellite photos only.

2 By closing stations less than one kilometer apart.

3 By hiding suburban branches on a separate paid website.

4 By keeping clean geometric lines while adding short-walk indicators or subtle river outlines.